

Kara Wang

Austin, TX · kara.sy.wang@gmail.com

EDUCATION

Westwood High School, Austin, TX

Class of 2027

Weighted GPA: 5.91/6.00, Rank 17/654 (top 2.6%) · Graduating with Distinguished Level of Achievement

SAT: 1520 (M: 790, R: 730) · AP Scholar with Distinction: 5s on AP Chemistry, Biology, Calculus AB, Environmental Science, Statistics, Computer Science A, Precalculus, World History, Chinese, Human Geography

RESEARCH & INTERNSHIPS

Computation Chemistry Researcher, UT Austin High School Research Academy

Summer 2025

- Evaluated Open Catalyst Project machine-learning potentials against density functional theory (DFT) methods for polyethylene glycol adsorption on zinc surfaces; presented research poster at symposium

Biochemistry & Pharmacology Researcher, CML Combination Therapy Research

Summer 2025

- Investigated biochemical pathways behind imatinib resistance in Chronic Myeloid Leukemia and combination therapy with curcumin, under Dr. Pallavi Phatale; presented findings to ~30 students and adults

Independent Literature Researcher, CASGEVY Gene Editing Therapy

2025–Present

- Investigated CRISPR-based therapy mechanisms for sickle cell disease; evaluated clinical efficacy, risk, and ethical considerations

ACTIVITIES & LEADERSHIP

Founder & Co-President, LetterLink Project

11th–Present

- Created a pen-pal and letters-of-encouragement program connecting isolated seniors and patients with student volunteers, delivering letters monthly to seniors across multiple local senior homes

Officer, WHS Orchestra

11th–Present

- Authored a comprehensive officer transition plan adopted by orchestra directors; led outreach initiatives that strengthened community engagement

Violinist, WHS Symphony/Philharmonic Orchestra

9th–Present

- First chair by competitive audition, with featured solo passages

Symphony Member, Austin Youth Orchestra

9th–10th

- Performed in a selective regional youth orchestra; contributed to a National Winner ensemble in the Mark of Excellence/National Orchestra Honors Project

Volunteer, Ronald McDonald House Charities (NICU Family Room)

12th

- Selected by competitive application to support families of hospitalized children at St. David's North Austin Medical Center

Volunteer Musician, Project Melody

9th–Present

- Performs violin and piano at senior homes to enhance resident engagement and well-being

HONORS & AWARDS

- Texas Federation of Music Clubs: 5x All-State Winner (Violin)
- National Orchestra Cup (Lincoln Center), 1st Runner-Up; TMEA #1 Texas Honor Full Orchestra (2026)
- Janice Kay Hodges Piano Competition: 2nd Place; 3rd Place (2x)
- Barbara James Volunteer Service Award, Bronze · Duke of Edinburgh's International Award, Bronze
- AP Scholar with Distinction

SKILLS

Technical: Java (certified, advanced), Python, R, HTML · BioRender, PubMed/PubChem research tools

Languages: Chinese, Advanced — State Seal of Biliteracy (2025)